

“Little Miss Anjali”

When Mrs Anshul saw Manu with a butterfly on his left shoulder she called him. Didn't he know that he was not **supposed to** wear any **brooch** on his uniform, she asked. Manu laughed loudly and so did other children, **annoying** her. She ordered silence and let Manu explain. He said it wasn't a brooch. It was a butterfly — for real.

Mrs Anshul was **amazed**. She tried to touch it but it flew away.

"It is gone... now go back to your place and open your book," she said. As Manu turned, the butterfly came back and sat on his shoulder. "She is my pet — Miss Anjali," he said.

Miss Anjali became a big distraction in the class. The children laughed, **chased** her and tried to hold her in hand. As each **competed** with the other there was **commotion** in the class. So Manu was told not to bring her to the class. He was sad. But rules were rules.

"Tomorrow Neerav may want to bring his puppy and Jyotsna her **kitten**... just imagine," Mrs Anshul had argued.

Manu had a potted plant in his balcony. That was Miss Anjali's **lodge** where she stayed at night though she went around with him all day. But the next day Manu told her to **get off** his shoulder when he left for school. He talked to her explaining that he would miss her too but he had to listen to the teacher.

Miss Anjali was sad. She flew to her potted plant and **perched** on a leaf. In the evening Manu came back from school and rushed to the balcony. Miss Anjali was not there. He went in search of her but could not find her anywhere in the house.

From that day he hated Mrs Anshul. He did not do the homework she gave him and got punished all the time. When she asked him any question he stood silent though he knew the answer.

"It is because I listened to her I lost my pet. I am not going to listen to her any more," Manu told his friends.

Mrs Anshul told him if he continued to **disobey** she may have to meet his parents.

"So what?" Manu thought and Anshul read his mind.

"So you don't care. What is wrong with you?"



"Miss, he lost his pet," Neerav answered for Manu. As Manu looked at her, his **eyes welled up**.

Mrs Anshul felt bad.

"It is okay. You can always get another one," she said.

Days passed. Manu was the same — **sullen, depressed**, not concentrating on his studies...

One fine day Mrs Anshul announced in class that the students had to do science projects for practicals. There would be a list of topics and the students would have to form groups and select the topic. As students started talking very excitedly, Mrs Anshul wrote the topics on the blackboard.

Gardener's friends, Sunlight, Herbs..... and BUTTERFLIES!

She said eight students could **volunteer** to be group leaders and each could select his team and the topic. Seven students stood up as the students tried to suggest the eighth

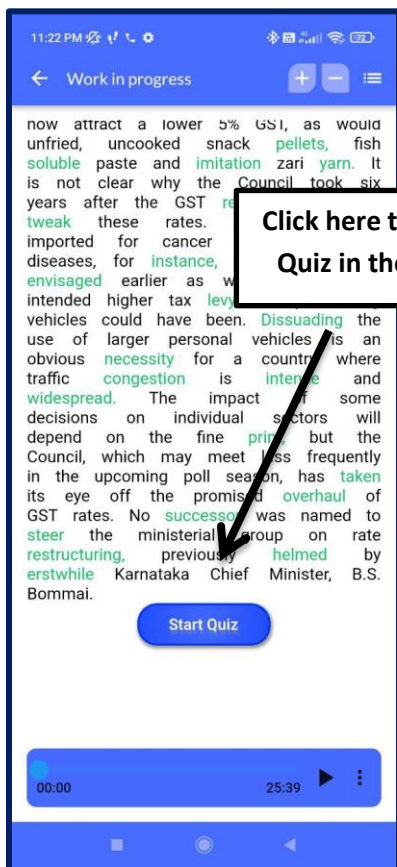
Manu stood **reluctantly** and the teacher said, 'Now guess what topic he will select. "Butterflies! The class shouted in one voice Manu **broke into a smile**.

...And then Manu was a busy boy, **cheerful**, leading his team to gardens and observing butterflies. He loved Mrs Anshul who helped him with plants which attract butterflies. He had a small garden in his balcony now. He woke up everyday to a colourful world.

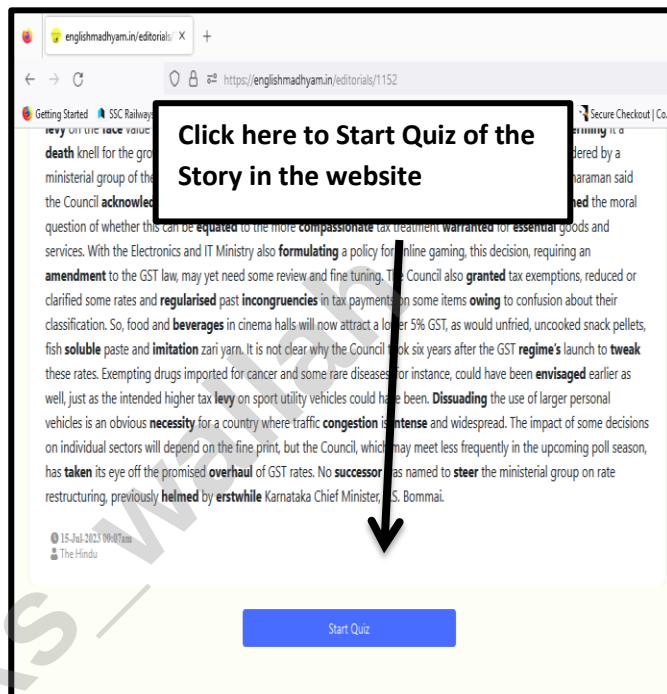
Vocabulary

1. (Be) **supposed** (to) (adjective) – expected, required, obligated, meant, intended – अपेक्षित होना / करना चाहिए
2. **Brooch** (noun) – pin, clasp, ornament, badge, jewellery – गहने में लगाया जाने वाला पिन
3. **Annoy** (verb) – irritate, bother, vex, anger, provoke – परेशान करना / चिढ़ाना
4. **Amazed** (adjective) – surprised, astonished, stunned, awed, flabbergasted – आश्चर्यचकित
5. **Chase** (verb) – pursue, run after, follow, hunt, trail – पीछा करना
6. **Compete** (verb) – contest, rival, vie, challenge, participate – प्रतिस्पर्धा करना
7. **Commotion** (noun) – uproar, disturbance, turmoil, chaos, racket – हंगामा / अफरा-तफरी
8. **Kitten** (noun) – young cat, kitty, feline baby, cub, pet – बिल्ली का बच्चा
9. **Lodge** (noun) – shelter, dwelling, hut, resting place, residence – विश्राम स्थान / छोटा आवास
10. **Get off** (phrasal verb) – dismount, descend, remove oneself, alight, step down – उतर जाना / हट जाना
11. **Perch** (verb) – rest, sit, roost, settle, alight – बैठना (किसी ऊँची जगह पर)
12. **Disobey** (verb) – defy, resist, ignore, rebel, violate – अवज्ञा करना / न मानना
13. **Eye well up** (phrase) – tear up, fill with tears, become moist, get emotional, blur – आँखों में आँसू आ जाना
14. **Sullen** (adjective) – gloomy, morose, moody, sulky, grumpy – रूखा / उदासीन
15. **Depressed** (adjective) – sad, gloomy, melancholic, downcast, dejected – उदास / अवसादग्रस्त
16. **Volunteer** (verb) – offer, enlist, propose, come forward, step up – स्वयंसेवक बनना / स्वेच्छा से करना
17. **Seek** (verb) – search, pursue, explore, look for, inquire – तलाश करना / खोजना
18. **Wise** (adjective) – intelligent, prudent, sagacious, insightful, knowledgeable – बुद्धिमान
19. **Reluctantly** (adverb) – unwillingly, hesitantly, grudgingly, unwilling, slowly – अनिच्छा से
20. **Break into a smile** (phrase) – smile suddenly, grin, beam, brighten up, express joy – अचानक मुस्कुरा देना
21. **Cheerful** (adjective) – happy, joyful, bright, spirited, content – प्रसन्न / खुशमिजाज

Practice Exercise



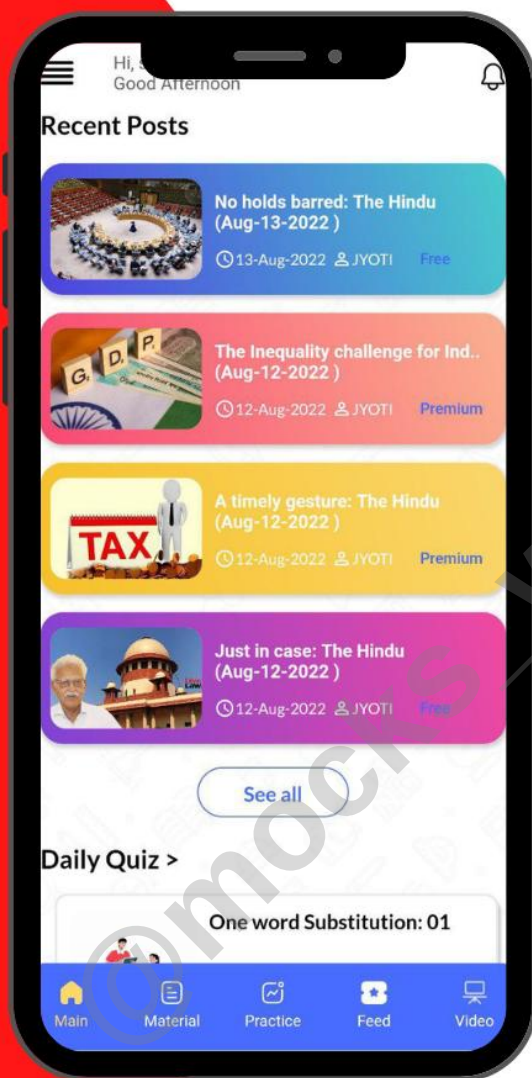
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